

ARCHAEOLOGY

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's come back to our own times – archaeology is far from standing still! In 2022 the world celebrated 100 years since the discovery of the tomb of Tutankhamun, and in 2025 the Grand Egyptian Museum near the pyramids of Giza fully opened, displaying his entire treasure. In 2023 artificial intelligence helped read the first word from the charred scrolls of Herculaneum, destroyed by the eruption of Vesuvius. The word was "porphyras," meaning purple. In 2024 a study showed that the Altar Stone at Stonehenge was brought all the way from northern Scotland, more than 700 km away. That same year lidar revealed a lost Maya city in Mexico, named Valeriana. Archaeologists increasingly study the past without digging, using aerial scans and ground radar. Svante Pääbo, who decoded the Neanderthal genome, received the 2022 Nobel Prize for research on ancient DNA. Sadly, since 2022 the war in Ukraine has also threatened monuments and museums. Remember these details – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏛️ The year 2022 marked 100 years since the discovery of the tomb of...
 - a) Cleopatra
 - b) Ramesses II
 - c) Khufu
 - d) Tutankhamun
2. 👁️ In 2023, artificial intelligence helped read the first word from the charred scrolls of...
 - a) Herculaneum
 - b) Troy
 - c) Qumran
 - d) Pompeii alone
3. 📖 The first word read from the Herculaneum scrolls was "porphyras," meaning...
 - a) bread
 - b) war
 - c) sea
 - d) purple
4. 🗺️ A 2024 study showed that the Altar Stone at Stonehenge was brought from...
 - a) Wales
 - b) Ireland
 - c) France
 - d) northern Scotland
5. 🗨️ The Grand Egyptian Museum near the pyramids of Giza fully opened in...
 - a) 2020
 - b) 2005
 - c) 2025
 - d) 2015
6. 🗿 In 2024, lidar revealed a lost Maya city in Mexico, named...
 - a) Atlantis
 - b) El Dorado
 - c) Valeriana
 - d) Machu Picchu
7. 💖 Archaeologists increasingly study the past without digging, using...
 - a) aerial scans and ground radar
 - b) dynamite
 - c) excavators
 - d) shovels
8. 🌿 Research on ancient DNA, honored with the 2022 Nobel Prize, is led by...
 - a) Marie Curie
 - b) Svante Pääbo
 - c) Jane Goodall
 - d) Howard Carter
9. ⭐ Since 2022, the war in Ukraine has also threatened...
 - a) only forests
 - b) nothing at all
 - c) only factories
 - d) monuments and museums

PHILOSOPHY

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's step into the present day, where philosophy is asking new questions. Music created by artificial intelligence raises the question of who its author is – philosophers and lawyers argue about it. AI ethics works, among other things, to make sure AI is safe and fair. Disinformation is dangerous too: it means deliberately spreading falsehoods. In the encyclical *Fratelli tutti* from 2020, Pope Francis wrote about the brotherhood of all people, and in *Dilexit nos* from 2024 about the love of the Heart of Jesus. Francis died in April 2025, on Easter Monday. The new pope, Leo XIV, chose a name recalling Leo XIII, who wrote about the social issues of the industrial age. The pandemic led many people to reflect on what matters most in life. And the question of whether we have duties toward future generations, for example regarding the climate, is a topic of intergenerational ethics. Remember these ideas – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 **Music created by artificial intelligence raises the question of...**
 - a) who its author is
 - b) what color it is
 - c) how loud to play it
 - d) how much the electricity costs
2. 👁️ **In the encyclical *Fratelli tutti* (2020), Pope Francis wrote about...**
 - a) sports
 - b) outer space
 - c) the market economy
 - d) the brotherhood of all people
3. 🗨️ **The new pope, Leo XIV (2025), chose a name recalling Leo XIII, who wrote about the...**
 - a) mysteries of outer space
 - b) world of sports
 - c) social issues of the industrial age
 - d) art of war
4. ⚖️ **"Disinformation" is...**
 - a) advertising
 - b) deliberately spreading falsehoods
 - c) an honest mistake
 - d) a poem
5. ⚡ **AI ethics is concerned, among other things, with making sure AI is...**
 - a) safe and fair
 - b) pretty
 - c) cheap
 - d) fast
6. 🙏 **Pope Francis's encyclical *Dilexit nos* (2024) is about...**
 - a) the love of the Heart of Jesus
 - b) war
 - c) work
 - d) ecology
7. 💖 **The pandemic led many people to reflect on...**
 - a) fashion
 - b) what matters most in life
 - c) shopping
 - d) advertising
8. 🌿 **The question of whether we have duties toward future generations, e.g. regarding the climate, is a topic of...**
 - a) sports
 - b) grammar
 - c) astronomy
 - d) intergenerational ethics
9. ☆ **Pope Francis died in...**
 - a) May 2023
 - b) January 2022
 - c) December 2020
 - d) April 2025

HISTORY

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's go back just a few years, to events your family remembers. Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine began on February 24, 2022. The war caused the largest refugee crisis Europe had seen since World War II, and charity concerts in Poland raised aid for Ukraine. After Russia's attack, Finland and Sweden joined NATO in 2023–2024. Earlier, in 2020, the United Kingdom left the European Union – that was Brexit. In 2022 Queen Elizabeth II died; she had reigned since 1952, a full 70 years. In Poland, the parliamentary elections in October 2023 had a record turnout of about 74%. In September 2024 a flood hit Lower Silesia and the Opole region hardest. And in the first half of 2025, Poland presided over the Council of the EU. Remember these events – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🇵🇱 After Russia's attack on Ukraine in 2022, charity concerts in Poland...
 - a) played only the anthem
 - b) raised aid for Ukraine
 - c) banned music
 - d) were all canceled
2. 🇷🇺 Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine began on...
 - a) February 24, 2022
 - b) November 11, 2021
 - c) September 1, 2020
 - d) May 3, 2023
3. 🇬🇧 The United Kingdom left the European Union (Brexit) in...
 - a) 2024
 - b) 2016
 - c) 2020
 - d) 2010
4. 👑 Queen Elizabeth II reigned from 1952 to 2022. For how many years?
5. 🇫🇮 In 2023–2024, Finland and Sweden...
 - a) joined NATO
 - b) declared absolute monarchies
 - c) merged into one country
 - d) left the EU
6. 🇵🇱 In the first half of 2025, Poland...
 - a) adopted the euro
 - b) left NATO
 - c) presided over the Council of the EU
 - d) hosted the Olympics
7. 🇵🇱 The parliamentary elections in Poland in October 2023 had...
 - a) a record turnout of about 74%
 - b) only one candidate
 - c) voting by phone
 - d) a turnout of 10%
8. 🇵🇱 The September 2024 flood in Poland hit hardest in...
 - a) Lower Silesia and the Opole region
 - b) Masuria
 - c) Pomerania
 - d) Podlasie
9. 🇺🇦 The war in Ukraine has caused, on a scale unseen in Europe since World War II, a...
 - a) drop in prices
 - b) refugee crisis
 - c) tourism boom
 - d) sports crisis

1. b 2. a 3. c 4. 70 5. a 6. c 7. a 8. a 9. b

ANSWERS



LINGUISTICS

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Listen to how language is changing in our times! In 2020 the word "coronavirus" entered everyday language. In 2022 ChatGPT was released – an AI language model that can also talk in Polish. Since 2024 the SpeakLeash community has been developing a Polish AI language model called Bielik. Poland's Youth Word of the Year 2023 was "rel," and Oxford's Word of the Year 2024 was "brain rot," meaning mental decay from shallow content online. In 2023 Twitter changed its name to X. Names for hurricanes and storms, such as Boris, are given by weather services, from set lists, to make warning people easier. Since 2022 the Ukrainian language has been heard much more often in Poland. And the 2024 Nobel Prize in Literature went to the Korean writer Han Kang. Remember these words – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

- 🇵🇱 Poland's Youth Word of the Year 2023 was...
 - "sztos"
 - "dzban"
 - "XD"
 - "rel"
- 👁️ Oxford's 2024 Word of the Year was "brain rot," meaning...
 - a new game
 - a plant disease
 - mental decay from shallow content
 - a trendy dance
- 📖 The word "coronavirus" entered everyday language in...
 - 2020
 - 2010
 - 2025
 - 2000
- 🗨️ ChatGPT, released in 2022, is...
 - a telephone
 - a board game
 - a paper dictionary
 - an AI language model
- 🇵🇱 The Polish AI language model developed since 2024 by the SpeakLeash community is called...
 - Bielik
 - Smok
 - Wiedźmin
 - Orzeł
- 🇺🇦 Since 2022, the Ukrainian language in Poland...
 - has been banned
 - has disappeared
 - has been heard much more often
 - has become an official language
- 💜 In 2023, Twitter changed its name to...
 - Bluebird
 - X
 - Tweet
 - Meta
- 🌪️ Names for hurricanes and storms, such as Boris, are given by...
 - weather services, from set lists
 - politicians
 - children in a contest
 - the military
- 🌟 The 2024 Nobel Prize in Literature went to the Korean writer...
 - Louise Glück
 - Annie Ernaux
 - Han Kang
 - Olga Tokarczuk

LITERARY STUDIES



11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's look into contemporary literature. In 2022 Olga Tokarczuk published *The Empusium*, a horror novel set in a sanatorium in Görbersdorf. The 2023 Nobel Prize in Literature went to the Norwegian writer Jon Fosse, and in 2025 to the Hungarian writer László Krasznahorkai, famous for very long sentences. In 2020–2025 e-books and audiobooks gained millions of new readers, and BookTok – recommending books on TikTok – helped promote many titles. Netflix's *The Witcher* series is based on the books of Andrzej Sapkowski. Joanna Kuciel-Frydryszak's 2023 book *Chłopki* ("Peasant Women"), about the lives of Polish village women, became a bestseller. That same year the animated film *The Peasants* was made, like *Loving Vincent*, from hand-painted frames. And reportage books about the war in Ukraine show the fates of ordinary people in wartime. Remember these titles – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏠 In 2022, Olga Tokarczuk published a horror novel set in a sanatorium in Görbersdorf, titled...
 - a) Flights
 - b) The Empusium
 - c) Primeval and Other Times
 - d) The Books of Jacob
2. 👁 The 2023 Nobel Prize in Literature went to the Norwegian writer...
 - a) Jon Fosse
 - b) Knut Hamsun
 - c) Jo Nesbø
 - d) Henrik Ibsen
3. 📖 The 2025 Nobel Prize in Literature went to the Hungarian writer...
 - a) László Krasznahorkai
 - b) Sándor Márai
 - c) Imre Kertész
 - d) Péter Esterházy
4. 📖 In 2020–2025, e-books and audiobooks...
 - a) became pricier than cars
 - b) disappeared
 - c) gained millions of new readers
 - d) were banned
5. 🎬 Netflix's The Witcher series (since 2019) is based on the books of...
 - a) Andrzej Sapkowski
 - b) Henryk Sienkiewicz
 - c) Stanisław Lem
 - d) J.R.R. Tolkien
6. 🗣 BookTok is...
 - a) recommending books on TikTok
 - b) a type of paper
 - c) a literary prize
 - d) a new bookstore
7. 💖 Joanna Kuciel-Frydryszak's book Chłopki ("Peasant Women," 2023) is about...
 - a) queens
 - b) athletes
 - c) outer space
 - d) the lives of Polish village women
8. 🎨 The animated film The Peasants (2023) was made, like Loving Vincent, from...
 - a) hand-painted frames
 - b) building blocks
 - c) phone photos
 - d) puppets
9. 🌟 Reportage books about the war in Ukraine show readers...
 - a) the fates of ordinary people in wartime
 - b) soccer scores
 - c) cooking recipes
 - d) weather forecasts

CULTURE AND RELIGION

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's take a look at the culture and religion of our days. During the pandemic, many parishes and theaters streamed their events online. In 2023 the coronation of King Charles III took place, and the Ulma family from Markowa were beatified – the first time a whole family was beatified. The 2023 film *Oppenheimer* tells the story of the creator of the atomic bomb, and Jerzy Skolimowski's 2022 film *EO* tells the story of a donkey. The 2024 Eurovision Song Contest was won by Nemo from Switzerland. In December 2024 Notre-Dame Cathedral in Paris reopened after the fire. In the Catholic Church, 2025 was a Jubilee Year with the motto "Pilgrims of Hope," and that year Cardinal Robert Prevost became Pope Leo XIV, the first pope born in the USA. Remember these events – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 **The 2024 Eurovision Song Contest was won by...**
 - a) Måneskin from Italy
 - b) ABBA
 - c) Nemo from Switzerland
 - d) Loreen from Sweden
2. 🏰 **Notre-Dame Cathedral in Paris reopened after the fire in...**
 - a) January 2020
 - b) July 2026
 - c) May 2022
 - d) December 2024
3. 🗨️ **In 2025, the cardinal who became Pope Leo XIV was...**
 - a) Peter Turkson
 - b) Pietro Parolin
 - c) Luis Tagle
 - d) Robert Prevost
4. 🏛️ **In the Catholic Church, 2025 was a Jubilee Year with the motto...**
 - a) "God Is Love"
 - b) "Open the Doors"
 - c) "Pilgrims of Hope"
 - d) "Be Not Afraid"
5. 🎬 **The film Oppenheimer (2023) tells the story of...**
 - a) a painter
 - b) a cosmonaut
 - c) a soccer player
 - d) the creator of the atomic bomb
6. 👑 **The coronation of King Charles III took place in...**
 - a) 2020
 - b) 2023
 - c) 2025
 - d) 2022
7. ❤️ **Jerzy Skolimowski's film EO (2022) tells the story of...**
 - a) a racehorse
 - b) a cat
 - c) a donkey
 - d) a dog
8. 🌿 **The Ulma family from Markowa were beatified in...**
 - a) 2023
 - b) 2013
 - c) 2003
 - d) 1993
9. ⭐ **During the pandemic, many parishes and theaters...**
 - a) streamed their events online
 - b) closed forever
 - c) moved to the Moon
 - d) banned music

ECONOMICS AND FINANCE

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's look at the economy of recent years. In 2021 the container ship Ever Given blocked the Suez Canal for 6 days. In 2022 energy prices in Europe rose sharply because of the war and cuts in Russian gas supplies. That same year the Baltic Pipe gas pipeline was launched, bringing gas to Poland from Norway. Inflation in Poland peaked in early 2023 at about 18%, and the cost-of-living crisis hit the poorest families hardest. In 2023 Croatia adopted the euro and joined the Schengen Area. Since 2024 Poland has paid the "800 plus" child benefit. After the pandemic, remote work became a permanent way of working for many. And Taylor Swift's The Eras Tour in 2023–2024 was the highest-grossing tour in history. Remember these numbers – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏆 **Taylor Swift's The Eras Tour (2023–2024) was...**
 - a) the highest-grossing tour in history
 - b) canceled
 - c) the shortest tour ever
 - d) free of charge
2. 👁 **Inflation in Poland peaked in early 2023 at about...**
 - a) 100%
 - b) 18%
 - c) 2%
 - d) 50%
3. 🗨 **The "800 plus" child benefit in Poland has been paid since...**
 - a) 2024
 - b) 2016
 - c) 2020
 - d) 2010
4. 🇸🇮 **In 2023, Croatia adopted...**
 - a) the euro and joined the Schengen Area
 - b) the pound
 - c) the Polish zloty
 - d) the dollar
5. 🚢 **In 2021, the container ship Ever Given blocked for 6 days...**
 - a) the Suez Canal
 - b) the Thames
 - c) the Panama Canal
 - d) the Vistula
6. 🌡 **Energy prices in Europe rose sharply in 2022 because of...**
 - a) a falling population
 - b) heat waves
 - c) the war and cuts in Russian gas supplies
 - d) too much wind
7. 💖 **After the pandemic, remote work...**
 - a) became a permanent way of working for many
 - b) disappeared
 - c) applies only to farmers
 - d) was banned
8. 🌿 **The Baltic Pipe gas pipeline, launched in 2022, brings gas to Poland from...**
 - a) Norway
 - b) Russia
 - c) the USA
 - d) Qatar
9. ⭐ **The cost-of-living crisis in 2022–2023 hit hardest...**
 - a) the poorest families
 - b) the richest people
 - c) no one
 - d) only companies

PSYCHOLOGY

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's talk about what has been happening in people's hearts and minds in recent years. During lockdown, music – such as singing from balconies in Italy – kept people's spirits up. Yet isolation increased problems with mood and anxiety among young people. After the lockdowns, contact with nature became an important way to relax, and outdoor physical activity helps reduce stress. In 2023 the WHO set up a commission on loneliness as a health problem. Too much screen time in children can worsen sleep and concentration, and using social media mindfully means controlling your time and content. Psychological help for people fleeing war is important, because war leaves deep psychological wounds. And if you need to talk, the helpline for children and young people in Poland is 116 111. Remember these tips – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 **Music during lockdown, such as singing from balconies in Italy,...**
 - a) kept people's spirits up
 - b) was banned
 - c) caused quarrels
 - d) interested no one
2. 👁️ **Too much screen time in children can...**
 - a) worsen sleep and concentration
 - b) replace exercise
 - c) improve eyesight
 - d) change nothing
3. 🗨️ **In 2023, the WHO set up a commission on...**
 - a) sports
 - b) outer space
 - c) loneliness as a health problem
 - d) fashion
4. 🛑 **Isolation during the pandemic increased among young people...**
 - a) sleep time in every case
 - b) the number of friends
 - c) physical activity
 - d) problems with mood and anxiety
5. 🏃 **Outdoor physical activity helps...**
 - a) increase anxiety
 - b) reduce stress
 - c) weaken memory
 - d) ruin sleep
6. 📞 **The helpline for children and young people in Poland is...**
 - a) 997
 - b) 112
 - c) 116 111
 - d) 999
7. 💖 **Using social media mindfully means, among other things, ...**
 - a) comparing yourself to others
 - b) controlling your time and content
 - c) scrolling all night
 - d) believing everything
8. 🌿 **After the lockdowns, contact with nature became...**
 - a) boring for everyone
 - b) an important way to relax
 - c) impossible
 - d) forbidden
9. ⭐ **Psychological help for people fleeing war is important because...**
 - a) food alone is enough
 - b) there is no need for it
 - c) war leaves deep psychological wounds
 - d) refugees are always happy

EDUCATION

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's peek into today's school. In March 2020 schools in Poland first switched to remote learning, and music lessons were held via video chat apps. After 2022, students from Ukraine learned alongside Polish children. Artificial intelligence raises the question of how to use it honestly for learning. Programming and robotics develop logical thinking, and media literacy education teaches how to spot fake news. Many countries are introducing school restrictions on the use of cell phones. "Green schools" and outdoor lessons help children get to know nature up close. And after 2020 Malala Yousafzai continues to fight for girls' education around the world. Remember these details – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 **During remote learning, music lessons were held...**
 - a) via video chat apps
 - b) in a concert hall
 - c) in a stadium
 - d) never at all
2. 👁️ **Schools in Poland first switched to remote learning in...**
 - a) January 2022
 - b) May 2024
 - c) March 2020
 - d) September 2019
3. 🗨️ **Artificial intelligence in school raises the question of how to...**
 - a) ban computers
 - b) close libraries
 - c) use it honestly for learning
 - d) abolish schools
4. ➡️ **After 2022, students from Ukraine in Polish schools...**
 - a) studied only in English
 - b) could not attend school
 - c) had lessons only at night
 - d) learned alongside Polish children
5. ⚙️ **Programming and robotics in schools develop...**
 - a) logical thinking
 - b) only strength
 - c) memory alone
 - d) nothing
6. 🚫 **Many countries are introducing school restrictions on the use of...**
 - a) blackboards
 - b) cell phones
 - c) balls
 - d) books
7. 💖 **Media literacy education teaches, among other things, how to...**
 - a) spot fake news
 - b) ride a bike
 - c) play chess
 - d) write in calligraphy
8. 🌿 **"Green schools" and outdoor lessons help children...**
 - a) get to know nature up close
 - b) spend more time on screens
 - c) never leave the classroom
 - d) avoid nature
9. ⭐ **After 2020, Malala Yousafzai continues to fight for...**
 - a) clean seas
 - b) a free internet
 - c) animal rights
 - d) girls' education around the world

SOCIOLOGY

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's take a look at society in our times. In 2022 the world's population passed 8 billion, and in 2023 India became the world's most populous country. In Poland the number of older people is growing – that is what an aging society means. Because of the pandemic, many families spent more time together at home. After 2022, Poland took in the most Ukrainian refugees of any EU country, because it borders Ukraine, and volunteers at the border handed out food and helped refugees. After 2019, the youth climate strikes Fridays for Future took place in Poland too. Social media can bring people together, but it can also spread hate and falsehoods. And in 2024 the Great Orchestra of Christmas Charity held its 32nd finale, raising money for hospital equipment. Remember these facts – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎻 In 2024, the Great Orchestra of Christmas Charity (WOŚP) held its...
a) 10th finale
b) 32nd finale
c) 50th finale
d) 1st finale
2. 👁 The world's population passed 8 billion in...
a) 2025
b) 2002
c) 2012
d) 2022
3. 🗨 In 2023, the world's most populous country became...
a) China
b) the USA
c) India
d) Indonesia
4. ➡ After 2022, Poland took in the most Ukrainian refugees of any EU country because...
a) it was decided by lot
b) it has the most people
c) it is the richest
d) it borders Ukraine
5. 🇺🇦 In 2022, volunteers at the Polish-Ukrainian border...
a) built a wall
b) organized soccer matches
c) handed out food and helped refugees
d) sold tickets
6. 👨👩👧👦 Because of the pandemic, many families...
a) all moved to the countryside
b) spent more time together at home
c) never saw each other
d) stopped using the internet
7. ❤ The aging of society in Poland means that...
a) the number of older people is growing
b) the number of children is growing
c) people are living shorter lives
d) everyone is young
8. 🌿 After 2019, youth climate strikes (Fridays for Future)...
a) happened only in Sweden
b) took place in Poland too
c) were banned
d) concerned only schools
9. ☆ Social media can bring people together, but it can also...
a) change nothing
b) only bring people together
c) spread hate and falsehoods
d) replace your family

LAW

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's see how law is changing in our times. In 2022 the ecological disaster on the Oder River sparked a debate about protecting rivers from pollution. In 2023 the UN High Seas Treaty, called BBNJ, was adopted. In 2024 the European Union adopted the Artificial Intelligence Act (AI Act). The EU Digital Services Act (DSA) requires large platforms to fight illegal content, and the GDPR gives everyone the right to access their own personal data. The EU has also decided that from 2035 new passenger cars may not emit CO₂. In 2025 the International Court of Justice issued an opinion that states have a duty to protect the climate, and the World Health Organization adopted an agreement on pandemic prevention. That same year Karol Nawrocki was elected president of Poland, taking office in August. Remember these laws – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏳️ The EU Artificial Intelligence Act (AI Act) was adopted in...
 - a) 2004
 - b) 2020
 - c) 2014
 - d) 2024
2. 👁️ The UN High Seas Treaty (BBNJ) was adopted in...
 - a) 2023
 - b) 1993
 - c) 2013
 - d) 2003
3. 🗳️ The president of Poland elected in 2025 was...
 - a) Andrzej Duda
 - b) Szymon Hołownia
 - c) Rafał Trzaskowski
 - d) Karol Nawrocki
4. 🚗 The European Union has decided that from 2035, new passenger cars...
 - a) must have 3 wheels
 - b) must be made of wood
 - c) may not emit CO₂
 - d) must be red
5. 📡 The EU Digital Services Act (DSA) requires large platforms to...
 - a) close accounts
 - b) fight illegal content
 - c) provide free internet
 - d) sell user data
6. 🏛️ In 2025, the International Court of Justice issued an opinion that states have a duty to...
 - a) wage wars
 - b) protect the climate
 - c) lower taxes
 - d) build roads
7. ❤️ The GDPR gives everyone the right to...
 - a) a free phone
 - b) access their own personal data
 - c) unlimited internet
 - d) a new surname
8. 🌿 The 2022 ecological disaster on the Oder River sparked a debate about...
 - a) a swimming ban
 - b) building motorways
 - c) fish prices
 - d) protecting rivers from pollution
9. 🌟 In 2025, the World Health Organization adopted an agreement on...
 - a) the climate
 - b) banning vaccinations
 - c) pandemic prevention
 - d) sports

OTHER (HUMANITIES)

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Finally, let's look at sports, music, and the big events of our days. The Tokyo Olympics were planned for 2020, but because of the pandemic they took place a year later – in 2021. The 2022 FIFA World Cup in Qatar was won by Argentina. In 2022 Varso Tower rose in Warsaw – the EU's tallest building. The 2023 Eurovision Song Contest was won by Loreen from Sweden with the song "Tattoo." The 2024 Paris Olympics opened with a ceremony on the Seine, and Aleksandra Mirosław won gold there in speed climbing. After the 2024 flood, the Great Orchestra of Christmas Charity raised money for flood victims. The motto "Pilgrims of Hope" accompanied the Jubilee Year 2025. And in 2025 Iga Świątek won Wimbledon, winning the final 6–0, 6–0. Remember these results – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 The 2023 Eurovision Song Contest was won by Loreen from Sweden with the song...
 - a) "Arcade"
 - b) "Tattoo"
 - c) "Waterloo"
 - d) "Euphoria"
2. 👁️ Varso Tower in Warsaw (2022) is...
 - a) the EU's tallest building
 - b) a bridge
 - c) a stadium
 - d) the lowest building
3. 🗨️ The motto "Pilgrims of Hope" accompanied the Jubilee Year...
 - a) 2016
 - b) 2020
 - c) 2025
 - d) 2000
4. 🇯🇵 The Tokyo Olympics were planned for 2020 but took place a year later because of the pandemic. In which year?

5. 🏆 At the 2024 Paris Olympics, Aleksandra Mirosław won gold in...
 - a) speed climbing
 - b) rowing
 - c) fencing
 - d) swimming
6. 🌍 The 2022 FIFA World Cup in Qatar was won by...
 - a) Brazil
 - b) Argentina
 - c) France
 - d) Poland
7. 💖 In 2025, Iga Świątek won Wimbledon, winning the final...
 - a) by walkover
 - b) in five sets
 - c) in a tiebreak
 - d) 6–0, 6–0
8. 🌿 The 2024 Paris Olympics opened with a ceremony on...
 - a) the Seine
 - b) a stadium in Warsaw
 - c) the Mediterranean Sea
 - d) the Eiffel Tower
9. ☆ After the 2024 flood, the Great Orchestra of Christmas Charity...
 - a) raised money for flood victims
 - b) moved abroad
 - c) stopped operating
 - d) switched to sports

1 b 2 a 3 c 4 2021 5 a 6 b 7 d 8 a 9 a

A N S W E R S

ARCHITECTURE AND URBAN PLANNING

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's take a walk through the cities of our times. During the pandemic, philharmonic orchestras and concert halls performed for audiences online. In 2023 Merdeka 118, the world's second-tallest building, was completed in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia. That same year the tunnel under the Świna River in Świnoujście opened – the longest underwater tunnel in Poland. After the 2023 earthquake in Turkey and Syria, rescuers searched for people under the rubble with the help of rescue dogs and listening equipment. Urban planners promote the "15-minute city," in which everything you need is close to home. Green roofs help retain water and cool buildings, and cities are planting more trees to fight urban heat islands. 3D-printed concrete buildings can be built in a few days. And rebuilding Ukraine's war-damaged cities will be a huge challenge for Europe. Remember these details – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 **During the pandemic, philharmonic orchestras and concert halls...**
 - a) played to full houses
 - b) were all turned into hospitals
 - c) performed for audiences online
 - d) were demolished
2. 🏢 **The world's second-tallest building, Merdeka 118 (2023), stands in...**
 - a) New York
 - b) Dubai
 - c) Kuala Lumpur
 - d) Warsaw
3. 🗨️ **The "15-minute city" is a concept in which...**
 - a) everything you need is close to home
 - b) buildings have 15 floors
 - c) there is a parking lot every 15 m
 - d) commuting takes 15 hours
4. 🌿 **Green roofs in cities help...**
 - a) heat the city in summer
 - b) increase noise
 - c) retain water and cool buildings
 - d) damage roofs
5. 🚒 **After the 2023 earthquake in Turkey and Syria, rescuers searched for people under the rubble with the help of, among others, ...**
 - a) rescue dogs and listening equipment
 - b) cats
 - c) horses
 - d) pigeons
6. 🚶 **The tunnel under the Świna River in Świnoujście, opened in 2023, is...**
 - a) a cable car
 - b) the longest underwater tunnel in Poland
 - c) a bridge
 - d) an airport
7. 💖 **3D-printed concrete buildings can be built in...**
 - a) a few minutes
 - b) a few days
 - c) no time at all
 - d) a few years
8. 🌿 **Cities are planting more trees to fight...**
 - a) birds
 - b) urban heat islands
 - c) rain
 - d) wind
9. ☆ **Rebuilding Ukraine's war-damaged cities will be...**
 - a) quick and simple
 - b) unnecessary
 - c) forbidden
 - d) a huge challenge for Europe



11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's look into the world of modern electronics. In 2020–2022 the chip, or semiconductor, shortage caused shortages of cars and electronics. After 2020 true wireless (TWS) earbuds became common; they connect to a phone via Bluetooth. Today's smartwatches can detect an irregular heartbeat. In Poland, heat pumps became very popular. An electric car is charged with electricity from a charger, either from the grid or at a charging station. In 2023–2024 Nvidia became one of the world's most valuable companies thanks to chips for artificial intelligence. In 2024 the Apple Vision Pro headset appeared, combining the real world with virtual objects, and the first patient with a Neuralink brain implant could move a cursor with his thoughts. In July 2024 the CrowdStrike outage showed that one update can bring the world to a halt. Remember these inventions – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎧 **True wireless (TWS) earbuds connect to a phone via...**
 - a) Bluetooth
 - b) FM radio
 - c) a cable
 - d) sound waves
2. 👁 **The chip (semiconductor) shortage of 2020–2022 caused...**
 - a) shortages of cars and electronics
 - b) more cars
 - c) cheaper phones
 - d) falling prices
3. 🗨 **In 2023–2024, Nvidia became one of the world's most valuable companies thanks to...**
 - a) banks
 - b) toys
 - c) cars
 - d) chips for artificial intelligence
4. ⚡ **An electric car is charged with...**
 - a) coal
 - b) gasoline
 - c) gas
 - d) electricity from a charger
5. 🧠 **A Neuralink brain implant was placed in its first patient in 2024. The patient could...**
 - a) read other people's minds
 - b) move a cursor with his thoughts
 - c) fly
 - d) see in the dark
6. 👤 **The Apple Vision Pro headset (2024) combines the real world with...**
 - a) smells
 - b) virtual objects
 - c) electricity
 - d) radio sound
7. ❤ **Today's smartwatches can detect...**
 - a) an irregular heartbeat
 - b) thoughts
 - c) lies
 - d) the weather on Mars
8. 🌿 **After 2020, heat pumps in Poland...**
 - a) were banned
 - b) were used only in airplanes
 - c) disappeared
 - d) became very popular
9. ⭐ **The CrowdStrike outage in July 2024 showed that...**
 - a) the internet does not exist
 - b) outages never happen
 - c) computers are always reliable
 - d) one update can bring the world to a halt

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND TELECOMMUNICATIONS

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's enter the digital world of our times. In 2020 video call apps such as Zoom and Teams became essential for work and school for millions. In 2021–2022 AI programs that create images from a description, such as DALL·E or Midjourney, appeared. ChatGPT reached 100 million users in about 2 months. Since about 2023 artificial intelligence has been able to generate songs with lyrics and vocals. Watch out for a "deepfake" – a fake image or video made with AI – and protect your accounts with two-factor authentication, which means an extra confirmation of your login. Starlink is a network of thousands of satellites that provide internet from space. In 2024 the Nobel Prize in Physics went to Hopfield and Hinton for the foundations of neural networks and machine learning, and the Nobel Prize in Chemistry went partly to the creators of AlphaFold, a program that predicts the shape of proteins. Remember these innovations – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 Since about 2023, artificial intelligence has been able to generate...
 - a) live concerts
 - b) real instruments
 - c) songs with lyrics and vocals
 - d) tickets
2. 🖼️ AI programs that create images from a description, such as DALL-E or Midjourney, appeared in...
 - a) 1990
 - b) 2010
 - c) 2021–2022
 - d) 2000
3. 🗨️ ChatGPT reached 100 million users in about...
 - a) 2 days
 - b) 20 years
 - c) 2 years
 - d) 2 months
4. 🎭 A "deepfake" is...
 - a) a fake image or video made with AI
 - b) a new phone
 - c) a type of music
 - d) a board game
5. 🌐 Starlink is a network of thousands of satellites that provide...
 - a) water
 - b) internet from space
 - c) electricity
 - d) fuel
6. 📺 In 2020, video call apps such as Zoom and Teams...
 - a) were unknown
 - b) became essential for work and school
 - c) worked only in China
 - d) were banned
7. ❤️ Two-factor authentication means...
 - a) typing your password twice
 - b) an extra confirmation of your login
 - c) two passwords on a sticky note
 - d) logging in twice a day
8. 🌿 The 2024 Nobel Prize in Chemistry went partly to the creators of AlphaFold, a program that predicts...
 - a) the weather
 - b) exchange rates
 - c) the shape of proteins
 - d) match results
9. ⭐ The 2024 Nobel Prize in Physics went to Hopfield and Hinton for the foundations of...
 - a) the internet
 - b) neural networks and machine learning
 - c) the laser
 - d) telephony

BIOMEDICAL ENGINEERING

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's look into the labs of biomedical engineers. During the pandemic the pulse oximeter became popular; it measures blood oxygen saturation. mRNA vaccines against COVID-19 were developed in record time – about one year, and the 2023 Nobel Prize in Medicine honored the research that made mRNA vaccines possible. In 2022 a human received for the first time a heart from a genetically modified pig. In 2023 the first CRISPR therapy, Casgevy, was approved to treat sickle cell disease, and the WHO recommended the R21 malaria vaccine, which could protect millions of children in Africa. Exoskeletons and rehabilitation robots help patients learn to walk again. AI apps help doctors analyze X-ray and CT scans. And in the future, 3D printing of tissue should make it possible to print organs for transplants. Remember these achievements – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 mRNA vaccines against COVID-19 were developed in record time – about...
 - a) a hundred years
 - b) ten years
 - c) one year
 - d) one day
2. 👁️ In 2022, a human received for the first time a heart from...
 - a) a horse
 - b) a monkey
 - c) a genetically modified pig
 - d) a robot
3. 🗨️ The first CRISPR therapy (Casgevy), approved in 2023, treats...
 - a) broken bones
 - b) tooth decay
 - c) sickle cell disease
 - d) a runny nose
4. ➡️ A pulse oximeter, popular during the pandemic, measures...
 - a) temperature
 - b) blood pressure
 - c) height
 - d) blood oxygen saturation
5. 🦾 Exoskeletons and rehabilitation robots help patients...
 - a) fly
 - b) learn to walk again
 - c) avoid exercise
 - d) swim without lessons
6. 🧑 The R21 malaria vaccine, recommended by the WHO in 2023, could protect...
 - a) millions of children in Africa
 - b) only adults in Europe
 - c) plants
 - d) animals
7. 💖 AI apps help doctors analyze...
 - a) cooking recipes
 - b) road maps
 - c) X-ray and CT scans
 - d) movies
8. 🌱 In the future, 3D printing of tissue (bioprinting) should make it possible to...
 - a) print organs for transplants
 - b) print banknotes
 - c) print dog food
 - d) print clothes
9. 🌟 The 2023 Nobel Prize in Medicine honored research that made possible...
 - a) eyeglasses
 - b) antibiotics
 - c) prostheses
 - d) mRNA vaccines

CHEMICAL ENGINEERING



11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's step into today's chemical plants and labs. The 2022 Nobel Prize in Chemistry was for "click" chemistry, which makes it possible to join molecules quickly and easily, like building blocks. In 2023 the prize went for quantum dots, which produce the colors in QLED TV screens, and in 2025 to the creators of metal-organic frameworks (MOFs), which can capture gases such as CO₂ and water from the air. The Polish inventor Olga Malinkiewicz develops solar cells made from perovskites. Recycling lithium batteries is important because they contain valuable and harmful metals. The 2022 Oder River disaster was linked to a bloom of golden algae, favored by high salinity and low water levels. Microplastics have been found in human blood and lungs, and the EU is restricting PFAS "forever chemicals" because they don't break down and cause harm. Meanwhile, the alleged discovery of the LK-99 superconductor in 2023 turned out to be false once others tested it. Remember these facts – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏆 The 2023 Nobel Prize in Chemistry was about quantum dots, which produce the colors in...
 - a) oil paints
 - b) crayons
 - c) QLED TV screens
 - d) stained glass
2. 👁️ Olga Malinkiewicz, a Polish inventor, develops solar cells made from...
 - a) window glass
 - b) wood
 - c) gold
 - d) perovskites
3. 🗨️ The 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry honored the creators of metal-organic frameworks (MOFs), which can...
 - a) turn lead into gold
 - b) capture gases such as CO₂ and water from the air
 - c) produce electricity from nothing
 - d) glow in the dark
4. ⚡ "Click" chemistry, awarded the 2022 Nobel Prize, makes it possible to join molecules...
 - a) not at all
 - b) only with fire
 - c) quickly and easily, like building blocks
 - d) very slowly
5. ♻️ Recycling lithium batteries is important because they...
 - a) are made of paper
 - b) are cheap
 - c) contain valuable and harmful metals
 - d) can never wear out
6. 🌊 The Oder River disaster (2022) was linked to a bloom of golden algae, which was favored by...
 - a) high salinity and low water levels
 - b) cold weather
 - c) clean water
 - d) lack of sunlight
7. 💖 The alleged discovery of the LK-99 superconductor in 2023 turned out to be...
 - a) a breakthrough
 - b) a piece of gold
 - c) false once others tested it
 - d) a military secret
8. 🌿 Microplastics have been found in...
 - a) the ocean only
 - b) nowhere
 - c) human blood and lungs
 - d) China only
9. ⭐ The EU is restricting PFAS "forever chemicals" because they...
 - a) taste sweet
 - b) are expensive
 - c) are green
 - d) don't break down and cause harm

CIVIL ENGINEERING AND TRANSPORT

**11. Present Day**

2020–2025 AD

Let's travel along the roads, canals and orbits of our times. The tallest building in the world in 2025 was the Burj Khalifa in Dubai. In 2021 the Perseverance rover landed on Mars, and the Ingenuity helicopter that came with it became the first aircraft to fly on Mars. In 2022 the canal cut through the Vistula Spit opened, allowing ships to sail to Elbląg, bypassing Russian waters. That year the DART mission tested whether it is possible to change an asteroid's orbit by impact, and the Artemis I mission sent the uncrewed Orion spacecraft around the Moon. In 2023 India's Chandrayaan-3 probe was the first to land near the Moon's south pole. In 2024 SpaceX's Starship for the first time saw its booster caught by the tower. Electric scooters and e-bikes in cities require new rules and bike lanes, and the Central Communication Port (CPK) is Poland's planned airport and railway hub. Remember these journeys – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🚩 The canal cut through the Vistula Spit, opened in 2022, allows ships to sail to...
 - a) Kraków
 - b) Warsaw
 - c) Berlin
 - d) Elbląg, bypassing Russian waters
2. 👁 Which building was the tallest in the world in 2025?
 - a) Petronas Towers
 - b) Empire State Building
 - c) Burj Khalifa in Dubai
 - d) Shanghai Tower
3. 🚁 The Ingenuity helicopter was the first aircraft to fly on...
 - a) Mars
 - b) the Moon
 - c) the Sun
 - d) Venus
4. 🚀 In 2024, SpaceX's Starship rocket for the first time...
 - a) saw its booster caught by the tower
 - b) took tourists to space
 - c) landed on the Moon
 - d) flew to Mars
5. 🇮🇳 In 2023, India's Chandrayaan-3 probe was the first to land...
 - a) near the Moon's south pole
 - b) on the Sun
 - c) on a comet
 - d) on Mars
6. 🌌 In 2022, the DART mission tested whether it is possible to...
 - a) change an asteroid's orbit by impact
 - b) land on the Sun
 - c) catch a comet
 - d) build a base on Mars
7. ❤ The Artemis I mission (2022) sent the uncrewed Orion spacecraft around...
 - a) the Sun
 - b) Jupiter
 - c) the Moon
 - d) Mars
8. 🍃 Electric scooters and e-bikes in cities require...
 - a) new rules and bike lanes
 - b) a ban on roads
 - c) horses
 - d) fuel
9. ☆ The Central Communication Port (CPK) is Poland's planned...
 - a) airport and railway hub
 - b) highway to Mars
 - c) artificial island
 - d) new sea

MATERIALS ENGINEERING

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's get to know the materials of our times. Cross-laminated timber (CLT) makes it possible to build even skyscrapers out of wood. Graphene is already used, for example, in batteries and sports equipment. Self-healing materials are ones that seal their own cracks – for example bacterial concrete, because the bacteria produce limestone that fills them. Fabrics made from recycled PET bottles are used in sportswear, and materials made from mycelium can replace polystyrene foam and leather. Photovoltaic panels are made mainly from silicon. Lithium mining for batteries raises concerns because it uses a lot of water in dry regions. And the James Webb Space Telescope, with mirrors made of gold-coated beryllium, sent its first images in 2022. Remember these materials – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🚩 **Cross-laminated timber (CLT) makes it possible to build out of wood even...**
 - a) skyscrapers
 - b) only dog kennels
 - c) spaceships
 - d) only drawbridges
2. 👁️ **In 2020–2025, graphene is already used, for example, in...**
 - a) only winter clothes
 - b) batteries and sports equipment
 - c) bread
 - d) money
3. 🗨️ **Self-healing materials are ones that...**
 - a) change color
 - b) seal their own cracks
 - c) glow
 - d) never break down
4. ➡️ **Bacterial concrete can repair cracks because the bacteria...**
 - a) produce limestone that fills them
 - b) eat the concrete
 - c) glow
 - d) bring in cement
5. ⚡️ **Fabrics made from recycled PET bottles are used in...**
 - a) sportswear
 - b) metal
 - c) glass
 - d) paper
6. 🧑‍🔬 **The James Webb Space Telescope has mirrors made of gold-coated beryllium. It sent its first images in...**
 - a) 2022
 - b) 2002
 - c) 2025
 - d) 2012
7. 💖 **Materials made from mycelium can replace...**
 - a) glass
 - b) steel
 - c) concrete in all cases
 - d) polystyrene foam and leather
8. 🌿 **Photovoltaic panels are made mainly from...**
 - a) silicon
 - b) plastic
 - c) gold
 - d) wood
9. ⭐️ **Lithium mining for batteries raises concerns because it...**
 - a) doesn't exist
 - b) uses a lot of water in dry regions
 - c) makes the air poisonous
 - d) is too cheap

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING



11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's meet the machines of our times. Humanoid robots, such as Boston Dynamics' Atlas, can run, jump and do backflips. Robots that clean, mow lawns and vacuum are increasingly common in homes. Driverless self-driving cars, or robotaxis, already operate in several cities in the USA and China. In agriculture, drones are used for spraying and monitoring crops, and they have played a huge role in the war in Ukraine. Offshore wind turbines now have rotors with a diameter of over 200 m. On Mars the Perseverance rover collects rock samples to bring back to Earth, and China's Tiangong space station has been operating since 2022. Will robots take people's jobs? Experts say they will change many jobs and create new ones. Remember these machines – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🚩 **Humanoid robots, such as Boston Dynamics' Atlas, can...**
 - a) run, jump and do backflips
 - b) sing opera
 - c) write poems
 - d) cook dinner for 100 people
2. 📺 **In agriculture, drones are used for...**
 - a) plowing
 - b) spraying and monitoring crops
 - c) sowing by hand
 - d) milking cows
3. 🗞 **Drones have played a huge role in the war in...**
 - a) Poland
 - b) Ukraine
 - c) Norway
 - d) Switzerland
4. 🚗 **Driverless self-driving cars (robotaxis) already operate in...**
 - a) several cities in the USA and China
 - b) nowhere
 - c) every city
 - d) Poland only
5. 🪐 **On Mars, the Perseverance rover collects...**
 - a) drinking water
 - b) stones for building houses
 - c) plants
 - d) rock samples to bring back to Earth
6. 🇨🇳 **China's Tiangong space station has been operating since...**
 - a) 2002
 - b) 1992
 - c) 2022
 - d) 2012
7. ❤ **Robots that clean, mow lawns and vacuum are, in today's homes,...**
 - a) increasingly common
 - b) banned
 - c) only in museums
 - d) unknown
8. 🌿 **Offshore wind turbines keep getting bigger – the newest have a rotor diameter of...**
 - a) 2 m
 - b) over 200 m
 - c) 20 m
 - d) 2 km
9. ☆ **Will robots take people's jobs? Experts say that they...**
 - a) do not exist
 - b) will change many jobs and create new ones
 - c) will change nothing
 - d) will leave everyone without work

1. a 2. b 3. b 4. a 5. d 6. c 7. a 8. b 9. b

ANSWERS



11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's talk about energy in our times. After 2020 solar power in Poland grew very fast on house rooftops, and energy storage is needed because sun and wind are variable. Poland's first nuclear power plant is planned in Pomerania, at the site called Lubiatowo-Kopalino. In December 2022, at the NIF laboratory in the USA, fusion for the first time yielded more energy than it used. In 2023 the COP28 climate conference in Dubai for the first time called for moving away from fossil fuels. 2024 was the warmest year on record and the first in which the average temperature exceeded 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels. In May 2024 the northern lights over Poland were caused by a magnetic storm from the Sun. The energy transition in Silesia means that miners are learning new trades. And saving energy at home means, for example, switching off unnecessary devices. Remember these facts – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏹 The northern lights seen over Poland in May 2024 were caused by...
 - a) moonlight reflected in clouds
 - b) a magnetic storm from the Sun
 - c) big-city lights
 - d) huge fireworks
2. 👁 Poland's first nuclear power plant is planned in Pomerania at the site called...
 - a) Suwałki
 - b) Bełchatów
 - c) Lubiatowo-Kopalino
 - d) Zakopane
3. 🗨 In December 2022, at the NIF laboratory in the USA, for the first time...
 - a) the Sun was ignited
 - b) nothing happened
 - c) a bomb was built
 - d) fusion yielded more energy than it used
4. ⚡ After 2020, solar power in Poland...
 - a) grew very fast on house rooftops
 - b) died out
 - c) worked only at night
 - d) was banned
5. 🔋 Energy storage (large batteries) is needed because...
 - a) electricity goes bad
 - b) sun and wind are variable
 - c) there is no grid
 - d) batteries are cheap
6. 🌍 The COP28 climate conference (2023) in Dubai for the first time called for...
 - a) moving away from fossil fuels
 - b) banning the sun
 - c) cutting down forests
 - d) building new mines
7. 💖 Saving energy at home means, for example, ...
 - a) leaving lights on overnight
 - b) opening windows with the heat on
 - c) running hot water nonstop
 - d) switching off unnecessary devices
8. 🍃 2024 was the warmest year on record and the first in which the average temperature exceeded...
 - a) 100°C
 - b) 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels
 - c) zero
 - d) 10°C
9. ☆ The energy transition in Silesia means that...
 - a) there is more coal
 - b) nothing is changing
 - c) mines are growing
 - d) miners are learning new trades

ASTRONOMY



11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's look up at the sky of our times. The Webb telescope has discovered galaxies so old that they existed soon after the Big Bang – just a few hundred million years later. In 2023 the Euclid telescope launched; it studies dark matter and dark energy. That same year the Voyager 1 probe stopped sending readable data, but engineers fixed it remotely from 24 billion km away. In April 2024 the solar eclipse was total in North America, and in the fall comet Tsuchinshan–ATLAS was visible to the naked eye over Poland. The solar maximum in 2024–2025 means more sunspots and auroras. In 2024 China's Chang'e 6 probe was the first to bring back samples from the far side of the Moon. Asteroid 2024 YR4 caused brief concern because it might hit Earth in 2032. And in 2025 Sławosz Uznański-Wiśniewski carried out more than a dozen Polish experiments on the ISS. Remember these discoveries – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🚩 In 2023, the Voyager 1 probe stopped sending readable data, but engineers...
 - a) gave up
 - b) fixed it remotely from 24 billion km away
 - c) brought it back to Earth
 - d) built a new one
2. 👁 The Euclid telescope (2023) studies...
 - a) the weather on Earth
 - b) sunspots only
 - c) the Moon
 - d) dark matter and dark energy
3. 🗨 In 2024, comet Tsuchinshan–ATLAS was...
 - a) visible to the naked eye over Poland
 - b) on the Moon
 - c) artificial
 - d) invisible
4. 🌑 The solar eclipse of April 2024 was total in...
 - a) Africa
 - b) Australia
 - c) Poland
 - d) North America
5. 🚀 In 2025, Sławosz Uznański-Wiśniewski carried out on the ISS...
 - a) a flight to Mars
 - b) a walk to the Moon
 - c) a repair of the Hubble telescope
 - d) more than a dozen Polish experiments
6. 🧑 In 2024, China's Chang'e 6 probe was the first to bring back samples from...
 - a) Mars
 - b) the far side of the Moon
 - c) the Sun
 - d) a comet
7. 💖 The Webb telescope has discovered galaxies so old that they...
 - a) do not shine
 - b) are on Earth
 - c) look as they did yesterday
 - d) existed soon after the Big Bang
8. 🌿 The solar maximum in 2024–2025 means...
 - a) the Sun going out
 - b) more sunspots and auroras
 - c) no light at all
 - d) the end of summer
9. ⭐ Asteroid 2024 YR4 caused brief concern because...
 - a) it was made of ice
 - b) it vanished
 - c) it struck Poland
 - d) it might hit Earth in 2032

MATHEMATICS



11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's look into the mathematics of our times. What is an algorithm? It is a step-by-step recipe. AI algorithms that create music rely on statistics and probability, and since 2023 weather forecasts have increasingly been produced by artificial intelligence models. During the pandemic, mathematical models showed that an R number greater than 1 means the epidemic is spreading. In 2023 an "einstein" was discovered – a single tile that covers a plane without repeating. The largest known prime number, discovered in 2024, has more than 41 million digits. In 2025 a Google DeepMind AI program performed at the International Mathematical Olympiad at the level of a gold medal. Mathematicians now check proofs with the help of computer proof assistants. And encrypting messages in messaging apps protects the privacy of conversations. Remember these numbers – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 **AI algorithms that create music rely on...**
 - a) notes on paper
 - b) statistics and probability
 - c) Roman numerals
 - d) an abacus
2. 👁️ **In 2023, an "einstein" was discovered – a single tile that...**
 - a) does not exist
 - b) is a circle
 - c) covers a plane without repeating
 - d) is a square
3. 🗨️ **The largest known prime number (discovered in 2024) has more than...**
 - a) 41 million digits
 - b) 4 digits
 - c) 410 digits
 - d) 41 digits
4. ➡️ **Mathematical models during the pandemic showed that an R number greater than 1 means the epidemic is...**
 - a) dying out
 - b) stopping
 - c) nonexistent
 - d) spreading
5. 🏆 **In 2025, a Google DeepMind AI program performed at the International Mathematical Olympiad at the level of...**
 - a) zero points
 - b) a single point
 - c) a gold medal
 - d) last place
6. 🧑🏫 **Mathematicians from different countries now collaborate by checking proofs with the help of...**
 - a) computer proof assistants
 - b) drawing lots
 - c) pocket calculators
 - d) fortune tellers
7. 💖 **What is an algorithm?**
 - a) a type of computer
 - b) a foreign language
 - c) a number
 - d) a step-by-step recipe
8. 🌿 **Since 2023, weather forecasts have increasingly been produced by...**
 - a) animals
 - b) coin tosses
 - c) fortune tellers
 - d) artificial intelligence models
9. ☆ **Encrypting messages in messaging apps protects...**
 - a) the privacy of conversations
 - b) only photos
 - c) nothing
 - d) ads

OTHER (TECHNOLOGY)



11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's look at the everyday technology of our times. During the pandemic, e-commerce platforms grew rapidly, and QR codes were used for showing menus and vaccination certificates. In 2020–2025 music streaming services became the main way people listen to music. The "Internet of Things" means home devices connected to the internet, and apps that identify plants and birds work thanks to artificial intelligence. Poland's mObywatel app lets you keep your ID documents on your phone. 3D printing at home lets you make spare parts and toys. The EU "right to repair" is meant to make devices easier and cheaper to repair. And since the end of 2024, USB-C chargers have been mandatory for phones in the EU. Remember these details – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 In 2020–2025, music streaming services became...
 - a) unknown
 - b) the main way people listen to music
 - c) banned
 - d) pricier than concerts
2. 👁 During the pandemic, QR codes were used, among other things, for...
 - a) showing menus and vaccination certificates
 - b) buying potatoes at the market
 - c) paying with coins
 - d) decorating walls
3. 🗨 The "Internet of Things" is...
 - a) an internet for animals
 - b) home devices connected to the internet
 - c) stores that sell things
 - d) books online
4. 🇵🇱 Poland's mObywatel app lets you...
 - a) keep your ID documents on your phone
 - b) make free phone calls
 - c) pay taxes in cash
 - d) buy plane tickets
5. 🖨 3D printing at home lets you...
 - a) print food out of nothing
 - b) print money
 - c) make spare parts and toys
 - d) clone animals
6. 🛒 During the pandemic, e-commerce platforms...
 - a) disappeared
 - b) all went bankrupt
 - c) were banned
 - d) grew rapidly
7. ❤ The EU "right to repair" is meant to make devices...
 - a) harder to repair
 - b) something you must throw away
 - c) easier and cheaper to repair
 - d) impossible to buy
8. 🌿 Apps that identify plants and birds work thanks to...
 - a) spy satellites
 - b) artificial intelligence
 - c) magic
 - d) luck
9. ⭐ USB-C chargers have been mandatory for phones in the EU since...
 - a) 2030
 - b) 2004
 - c) the end of 2024
 - d) 2014

BIOLOGY

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's take a look at the biology of our times. The SARS-CoV-2 virus kept changing into new variants because viruses mutate quickly. The 2024 Nobel Prize in Medicine was for the discovery of microRNA, which regulates genes. Research from 2020–2025 showed that plants under stress, such as drought, give off ultrasonic "clicks." Scientists describe new species every year – in those years, among others, new species of frogs, insects and orchids. Yet reports warn that about a million species are threatened with extinction. In 2025 the company Colossal announced it had bred puppies resembling the extinct dire wolf. The 2022 Oder River disaster was caused by a bloom of toxic golden algae. In cities, pollinators such as bees need flower meadows and insect hotels. And apps that identify birds by their calls let anyone get to know local birds. Remember these discoveries – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏆 Research from 2020–2025 showed that plants under stress (e.g. drought) give off...
 - a) screams audible to humans
 - b) ultrasonic "clicks"
 - c) melodies
 - d) songs
2. 👁 The 2024 Nobel Prize in Medicine was for the discovery of...
 - a) DNA
 - b) microRNA, which regulates genes
 - c) penicillin
 - d) insulin
3. 🗨 In 2025, the company Colossal announced it had bred puppies resembling the extinct...
 - a) Tyrannosaurus
 - b) mammoth
 - c) dodo
 - d) dire wolf
4. ➡ The SARS-CoV-2 virus kept changing into new variants because...
 - a) people gave it names
 - b) viruses mutate quickly
 - c) someone painted them
 - d) the seasons changed
5. 🌟 Scientists discover new species every year – in 2020–2025 they described, among others, new species of...
 - a) frogs, insects and orchids
 - b) dragons
 - c) living dinosaurs
 - d) unicorns
6. 🐝 In cities, pollinators such as bees need...
 - a) flower meadows and insect hotels
 - b) asphalt
 - c) parking lots
 - d) concrete
7. 💖 Apps that identify birds by their calls let anyone...
 - a) control birds
 - b) record dreams
 - c) breed birds
 - d) get to know local birds
8. 🍃 The 2022 Oder River disaster was caused by...
 - a) too many fish
 - b) a bloom of toxic golden algae
 - c) an earthquake
 - d) a volcanic eruption
9. ☆ Scientific reports warn that about a million species...
 - a) live in zoos
 - b) do not exist
 - c) are threatened with extinction
 - d) have already died out

CHEMISTRY

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's peek into a chemist's lab in our times. During the pandemic, surgical masks were made mainly of polypropylene. Hand sanitizer usually contains alcohol, and soap removes viruses from your hands because it breaks down their fatty envelope. The 2022 Nobel Prize in Chemistry was for "click" chemistry – it was the second Nobel for Barry Sharpless. In 2024 the concentration of CO₂ in the atmosphere exceeded 420 ppm. Green hydrogen is produced by splitting water using electricity from renewable sources. Many countries are jointly limiting single-use plastics because they pollute the oceans, and chemists are looking for plastic substitutes made from algae, starch and fungi. There is good news too: acid rain has become rarer than in the 1980s because sulfur dioxide emissions were cut. Remember these facts – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏆 The 2022 Nobel Prize in Chemistry was for "click" chemistry – it was the second Nobel for...
 - a) Barry Sharpless
 - b) Fred Sanger
 - c) Linus Pauling
 - d) Marie Curie
2. 👁 Surgical masks during the pandemic were made mainly of...
 - a) cotton
 - b) paper
 - c) silk
 - d) polypropylene
3. 🗨 Hand sanitizer usually contains...
 - a) alcohol
 - b) salt
 - c) oil
 - d) sugar
4. 🧼 Soap removes viruses from your hands because it...
 - a) freezes them
 - b) feeds them
 - c) breaks down their fatty envelope
 - d) dyes them
5. ⚡ Green hydrogen is produced by splitting water using electricity from...
 - a) gas
 - b) oil
 - c) renewable sources
 - d) coal
6. 🌍 Many countries are jointly limiting single-use plastics because they...
 - a) pollute the oceans
 - b) are expensive
 - c) last too long on shelves
 - d) are heavy
7. 💚 Acid rain has become rarer than in the 1980s because...
 - a) it stopped raining
 - b) sulfur dioxide emissions were cut
 - c) volcanoes went quiet
 - d) there are more cars
8. 🌿 In 2024, the concentration of CO₂ in the atmosphere exceeded...
 - a) 420 ppm
 - b) 4,200 ppm
 - c) 4 ppm
 - d) 42 ppm
9. ☆ Chemists are looking for plastic substitutes made, for example, from...
 - a) asbestos
 - b) algae, starch and fungi
 - c) mercury
 - d) lead

PHYSICS

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's step into the world of modern physics. The 2022 Nobel Prize in Physics was for quantum entanglement, which Einstein called "spooky action at a distance." In 2023 the prize honored attosecond pulses of light, which make it possible to observe the movement of electrons, and in 2025 quantum phenomena in circuits visible to the naked eye. A quantum computer calculates using qubits. In 2020 the Beirut port explosion, one of the largest non-nuclear explosions ever, was caused by ammonium nitrate stored for years. In 2022 the eruption of the Hunga Tonga volcano created a pressure wave that circled the Earth several times. Heat waves are becoming more frequent because the climate is warming, and satellites measure that Greenland's glaciers lose hundreds of billions of tons of ice yearly. And in 2025 Armand Duplantis's pole vault world record exceeded 6.20 m. Remember these phenomena – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏆 The 2023 Nobel Prize in Physics was for attosecond pulses of light, which make it possible to...
 - a) listen to the stars
 - b) cook
 - c) measure height
 - d) observe the movement of electrons
2. 👁 The 2022 Nobel Prize in Physics was for quantum entanglement, which Einstein called...
 - a) "a mistake"
 - b) "a miracle of nature"
 - c) "a joke"
 - d) "spooky action at a distance"
3. 🖨 A quantum computer calculates using...
 - a) ordinary bits only
 - b) gears
 - c) qubits
 - d) vacuum tubes
4. ⚖ The 2025 Nobel Prize in Physics was for quantum phenomena in...
 - a) stars
 - b) stones
 - c) human bodies
 - d) circuits visible to the naked eye
5. 🌋 The eruption of the Hunga Tonga volcano (2022) created a pressure wave that...
 - a) circled the Earth several times
 - b) could not be felt
 - c) froze the ocean
 - d) stopped at Tonga
6. 💣 The Beirut port explosion (2020) was one of the largest non-nuclear explosions ever, caused by...
 - a) a meteorite
 - b) natural gas
 - c) ammonium nitrate stored for years
 - d) a volcano
7. 🏆 Armand Duplantis's pole vault world record (2025) exceeded...
 - a) 6.20 m
 - b) 10 m
 - c) 3 m
 - d) 5 m
8. 🌿 Heat waves are becoming more frequent because...
 - a) the climate is warming
 - b) the time of day is changing
 - c) the Earth is stopping
 - d) the Sun is getting closer
9. ☆ Satellites make it possible to measure that Greenland's glaciers...
 - a) lose hundreds of billions of tons yearly
 - b) are not changing
 - c) are growing
 - d) are made of plastic

ENVIRONMENT

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's look at the environment in recent years. During the 2020 lockdown, birds could be heard more clearly in cities, because traffic had dropped. In 2022 the drought in Europe meant that rivers had very low water levels. That same year the Kunming-Montreal agreement set the goal to protect 30% of land and sea by 2030. The European Green Deal aims for the EU to become climate-neutral by 2050. In 2023 wildfires in Canada caused smoke to haze the skies over New York, and the extent of sea ice around Antarctica was a record low. In September 2024 the flood in Poland was caused by a low-pressure system that brought extreme rainfall in the mountains. Climate change affects the poorest countries most severely. And the "Clean Up the World" campaign or tree planting are examples of local action for the environment. Remember these events – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🚩 **During the 2020 lockdown in cities,...**
 - a) birds were forbidden to sing
 - b) birds could be heard more clearly
 - c) it was noisier
 - d) there were no birds
2. 👁️ **The 2023 wildfires in Canada caused...**
 - a) smoke to haze the skies over New York
 - b) snow to fall
 - c) cold weather
 - d) nothing unusual
3. 🗨️ **The European Green Deal aims for the EU to become climate-neutral by...**
 - a) 2030
 - b) 2100
 - c) 2025
 - d) 2050
4. 🧊 **In 2023, the extent of sea ice around Antarctica was...**
 - a) zero
 - b) the same as always
 - c) a record high
 - d) a record low
5. ✂️ **The "Clean Up the World" campaign or tree planting are examples of...**
 - a) handwriting lessons
 - b) sports
 - c) local action for the environment
 - d) trade
6. 🌍 **The Kunming-Montreal agreement (2022) aims to protect...**
 - a) all cities
 - b) 30% of land and sea by 2030
 - c) only Antarctica
 - d) 1% of forests
7. 💖 **The 2022 drought in Europe meant that...**
 - a) the seas froze
 - b) there was no summer
 - c) rivers had very low water levels
 - d) it snowed in summer
8. 🌿 **The September 2024 flood in Poland was caused by a low-pressure system that brought...**
 - a) only tornadoes
 - b) a heat wave
 - c) extreme rainfall in the mountains
 - d) a blizzard
9. ☆ **Climate change affects most severely...**
 - a) only the Arctic
 - b) no one
 - c) the richest people
 - d) the poorest countries

HEALTH

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's talk about health in our times. During the pandemic, hospitals encouraged staff to sing and dance together because it helped them cope with stress. COVID-19 antigen tests detect proteins of the virus, and "long COVID" means symptoms lasting for months after the illness. Vaccines for poor countries were distributed by the program COVAX. In May 2023 the WHO declared the end of the COVID-19 global health emergency. In 2025 the WHO Pandemic Agreement was adopted, which aims to ensure that in the next pandemic vaccines reach all countries fairly. In 2024 H5N1 bird flu began infecting dairy cows in the USA. Heat waves are especially dangerous for older people and young children. And for good health, the WHO recommends that adults get at least 150 minutes of moderate activity each week. Remember these tips – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏴 During the pandemic, hospitals encouraged staff to sing and dance together because...
 - a) it cured the virus
 - b) it replaced breaks
 - c) it was mandatory
 - d) it helped them cope with stress
2. 👁 The WHO declared the end of the COVID-19 global health emergency in...
 - a) December 2021
 - b) May 2020
 - c) January 2025
 - d) May 2023
3. 🗨 "Long COVID" means...
 - a) a new drug
 - b) a type of test
 - c) symptoms lasting for months
 - d) the name of a vaccine
4. ⚖ COVID-19 antigen tests detect...
 - a) bacteria
 - b) proteins of the virus
 - c) vitamins
 - d) sugar
5. ⚡ The WHO recommends that adults get each week at least...
 - a) 10 hours of sleep
 - b) 150 minutes of moderate activity
 - c) 3 minutes of running
 - d) 5 minutes of exercise
6. 🌐 COVID-19 vaccines for poor countries were distributed by the program...
 - a) UNESCO
 - b) NATO
 - c) COVAX
 - d) FIFA
7. ❤ Heat waves are especially dangerous for...
 - a) older people and young children
 - b) no one
 - c) athletes in every case
 - d) teenagers only
8. 🦅 In 2024, H5N1 bird flu began infecting in the USA...
 - a) horses
 - b) only pet cats
 - c) dairy cows
 - d) dogs
9. ☆ The WHO Pandemic Agreement (2025) aims to ensure that in the next pandemic...
 - a) no one gets sick
 - b) vaccines reach all countries fairly
 - c) borders close forever
 - d) there will be no vaccines

PHYSICAL CULTURE AND SPORT



11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's head to today's stadiums and tennis courts. In 2020 soccer matches were played without fans, so TV broadcasters added artificial crowd noise from recordings. In October of that year Iga Świątek won Roland Garros (the French Open) – her first Grand Slam tournament – and in 2022 she became the world No. 1 in women's tennis. In the 2020/2021 season Robert Lewandowski scored 41 Bundesliga goals, breaking the record of Gerd Müller. At the Tokyo 2020 Olympics, held in 2021, Poland won gold in, among other events, the mixed 4×400 m relay. The 2022 Beijing Winter Olympics were held mainly on artificial snow, and after 2022 athletes from Russia were excluded or competed as neutrals. Euro 2024 was won by Spain. At Paris 2024 the Polish men's volleyball team won an Olympic silver medal, and Julia Szeremeta won silver in boxing. Remember these victories – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎧 In 2020, soccer matches were played without fans, so TV broadcasters added...
 - a) artificial crowd noise from recordings
 - b) silence
 - c) classical music
 - d) commercials
2. 👁 In 2022, Iga Świątek became...
 - a) the world No. 1 in women's tennis
 - b) a world swimming champion
 - c) a pilot
 - d) the national team's coach
3. 🏐 At Paris 2024, the Polish men's volleyball team won...
 - a) a gold medal
 - b) fourth place
 - c) bronze
 - d) an Olympic silver medal
4. ⚽ In the 2020/2021 season, Robert Lewandowski scored 41 Bundesliga goals, breaking the record of...
 - a) Ronaldo
 - b) Pelé
 - c) Messi
 - d) Gerd Müller
5. 🏆 Which Grand Slam tournament did Iga Świątek win first?
 - a) Wimbledon
 - b) Australian Open
 - c) Roland Garros (French Open)
 - d) US Open
6. 🇪🇺 Euro 2024, the European soccer championship, was won by...
 - a) Poland
 - b) Germany
 - c) England
 - d) Spain
7. ❤ At the Tokyo 2020 Olympics (held in 2021), Poland won gold in, among other events, ...
 - a) soccer
 - b) hockey
 - c) basketball
 - d) the mixed 4×400 m relay
8. 🍃 The 2022 Beijing Winter Olympics were held mainly on...
 - a) a natural glacier
 - b) artificial snow
 - c) sand
 - d) grass
9. ☆ After 2022, athletes from Russia...
 - a) hosted the Olympics
 - b) did not exist
 - c) won everything
 - d) were excluded or competed as neutrals

MEDICINE

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's look into modern medicine. During the pandemic, ventilators helped patients breathe. The 2023 Nobel Prize went to Katalin Karikó, an mRNA researcher who comes from Hungary. The 2025 Nobel Prize in Medicine was for immune tolerance – how the immune system does not attack the body itself. In 2020–2025 da Vinci surgical robots are found in many hospitals in Poland, and the first gene therapies for spinal muscular atrophy (SMA) are reimbursed and saving children's lives. In 2022–2025 doctors and paramedics from Poland helped in Ukraine. Music therapy in hospitals helps reduce patients' pain and anxiety. The Red Cross and the WHO also fought epidemics of cholera and measles. Vaccination against measles is important because measles is dangerous and spreads easily. Remember this information – I'll ask you about it in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 **Music therapy in hospitals helps...**
 - a) reduce patients' pain and anxiety
 - b) replace surgery
 - c) remove viruses
 - d) heal broken bones
2. 👁️ **During the pandemic, ventilators helped patients...**
 - a) walk
 - b) breathe
 - c) speak
 - d) see
3. 🗨️ **Katalin Karikó, the 2023 Nobel laureate, comes from...**
 - a) Sweden
 - b) Japan
 - c) Poland
 - d) Hungary
4. ⚖️ **The 2025 Nobel Prize in Medicine was for immune tolerance, that is, how the immune system...**
 - a) sleeps
 - b) does not attack the body itself
 - c) grows
 - d) attacks everything
5. 🤖 **In 2020–2025, da Vinci surgical robots in Poland are...**
 - a) only in museums
 - b) found in many hospitals
 - c) unknown
 - d) banned
6. 🧑 **In 2022–2025, doctors and paramedics from Poland helped in...**
 - a) Mars
 - b) Antarctica
 - c) the Moon
 - d) Ukraine
7. ❤️ **The first gene therapies for spinal muscular atrophy (SMA) in Poland are...**
 - a) reimbursed and saving children's lives
 - b) free only for adults
 - c) unknown
 - d) banned
8. 🌿 **In 2020–2025, the Red Cross and the WHO also fought epidemics of...**
 - a) plague in Europe
 - b) smallpox
 - c) leprosy in Poland
 - d) cholera and measles
9. ⭐ **Vaccination against measles is important because...**
 - a) it is free and nothing more
 - b) measles is dangerous and spreads easily
 - c) measles does not exist
 - d) it is a fashion

PHARMACY

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's step into a modern pharmacy. Since 2020 Poland has used e-prescriptions – the patient receives a four-digit code. The antiviral drug Paxlovid was used to treat COVID-19, and in 2020–2025 the European Union jointly bought vaccines for all member states. In 2022–2023 shortages of some medicines were caused by disruptions in supply chains. GLP-1 agonist drugs, such as semaglutide, became famous as drugs for diabetes and obesity. Remember that antibiotics do not help against a cold caused by a virus. Expired medicines should be returned to a pharmacy, because drug residues in rivers can harm fish and other aquatic organisms. And artificial intelligence speeds up drug discovery because it quickly predicts how molecules act. Remember these details – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🏠 The antiviral drug Paxlovid was used to treat...
 - a) stomach flu
 - b) COVID-19
 - c) tooth decay
 - d) broken bones
2. 👁 GLP-1 agonist drugs, such as semaglutide, became famous as drugs for...
 - a) diabetes and obesity
 - b) toothache
 - c) insomnia
 - d) a runny nose
3. 📄 E-prescriptions have been used in Poland since 2020 – the patient receives...
 - a) always a paper prescription
 - b) a registered letter
 - c) a telegram
 - d) a four-digit code
4. ⚖ Shortages of some medicines in 2022–2023 were caused by...
 - a) disruptions in supply chains
 - b) a lack of diseases
 - c) too many pharmacies
 - d) a ban on medicines
5. 🔥 Expired medicines should be...
 - a) burned in a stove
 - b) flushed down the toilet
 - c) returned to a pharmacy
 - d) thrown into the forest
6. 🌍 In 2020–2025, the European Union jointly...
 - a) banned vaccines
 - b) closed pharmacies
 - c) sold medicines to Mars
 - d) bought vaccines for all member states
7. ❤ Antibiotics do not help against...
 - a) bacterial strep throat
 - b) a cold caused by a virus
 - c) a wound infection
 - d) bacterial pneumonia
8. 🌿 Drug residues in rivers can harm...
 - a) cars
 - b) clouds
 - c) fish and other aquatic organisms
 - d) stones
9. ⭐ Artificial intelligence speeds up drug discovery because it...
 - a) produces pills
 - b) quickly predicts how molecules act
 - c) tastes medicines
 - d) replaces doctors

AGRICULTURE

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's head out to the fields of our times. Ukraine, called "the breadbasket of Europe," mainly exports grain and sunflower oil. When the war broke out, the Black Sea Grain Initiative in 2022–2023 made it possible to export Ukrainian grain by sea. The war showed that food security depends on peace and trade. In 2024 farmers' protests in Poland and Europe were about, among other things, grain imports and Green Deal rules. Because of droughts, farmers increasingly irrigate fields and retain water, and precision farming with drones and sensors makes it possible to cut down on fertilizer and water. Vertical farms in cities grow plants on many floors under LED lights. Cultivated meat was first approved for sale in Singapore in 2020. And you can reduce food waste at home by planning shopping and freezing leftovers. Remember these details – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🚩 The 2024 farmers' protests in Poland and Europe were about, among other things, ...
 - a) music
 - b) ticket prices
 - c) grain imports and Green Deal rules
 - d) schools
2. 👁️ Ukraine, called "the breadbasket of Europe," mainly exports...
 - a) oil
 - b) cars
 - c) grain and sunflower oil
 - d) phones
3. 📄 Precision farming with drones and sensors makes it possible to...
 - a) cut down on fertilizer and water
 - b) give up on plants
 - c) grow crops without sunlight
 - d) use more water
4. 🏠 Vertical farms in cities grow plants...
 - a) on many floors under LED lights
 - b) in garden soil
 - c) in fields
 - d) on rooftops only
5. 🌵 Because of droughts in Poland, farmers increasingly...
 - a) stop working
 - b) irrigate fields and retain water
 - c) plant rice
 - d) raise camels
6. 🌐 The Black Sea Grain Initiative (2022–2023) made it possible to...
 - a) ban grain
 - b) export Ukrainian grain by sea
 - c) sell grain to Mars
 - d) burn grain
7. 💖 You can reduce food waste at home, for example, by...
 - a) buying more
 - b) planning shopping and freezing leftovers
 - c) throwing food out right away
 - d) not checking dates
8. 🌱 Cultivated (cell-grown) meat was first approved for sale in...
 - a) Egypt (1990)
 - b) France (1980)
 - c) Singapore (2020)
 - d) Poland (2000)
9. ⭐ The war in Ukraine showed that food security...
 - a) is always guaranteed
 - b) concerns only the rich
 - c) does not matter
 - d) depends on peace and trade

VETERINARY SCIENCE

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's visit the veterinarians of our times. During the pandemic, dogs that detect COVID-19 by smell were tested at airports because they could sniff out the infection. The "One Health" idea gained importance because many diseases come from animals. Animal adoptions from shelters rose, as people sought companionship. In 2022 pets from Ukraine were admitted into Poland under simplified rules, and zoo vets in Ukraine evacuated animals to safe places. In Poland, African swine fever (ASF) is spread mainly by wild boars. In 2020–2025 bird flu killed millions of wild birds and poultry. In Poland, vaccinating dogs against rabies is mandatory. And more and more cities are banning the sale of fireworks because the noise terrifies animals. Remember these facts – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🐶 **Dogs that detect COVID-19 by smell were tested at airports because they...**
 - a) could read test results
 - b) barked at the virus
 - c) knew medicine
 - d) could sniff out the infection
2. 🦋 **In Poland, African swine fever (ASF) is spread mainly by...**
 - a) birds
 - b) cats
 - c) wild boars
 - d) fish
3. 🇺🇦 **In 2022, pets from Ukraine were admitted into Poland...**
 - a) not at all
 - b) only if they were cats
 - c) only if they were birds
 - d) under simplified rules
4. 🇵🇱 **In Poland, vaccinating dogs against rabies is...**
 - a) mandatory
 - b) banned
 - c) voluntary for cats only
 - d) unknown
5. 🇺🇦 **During the war, zoo vets in Ukraine...**
 - a) released them onto the streets
 - b) evacuated animals to safe places
 - c) sold them
 - d) stopped working
6. 🧑 **The "One Health" idea gained importance after the pandemic because...**
 - a) many diseases come from animals
 - b) animals don't get sick
 - c) health is boring
 - d) people don't get sick
7. 💖 **During the pandemic, animal adoptions from shelters...**
 - a) dropped to zero
 - b) rose, as people sought companionship
 - c) did not exist
 - d) were banned
8. 🐦 **In 2020–2025, bird flu killed millions of...**
 - a) wild birds and poultry
 - b) insects
 - c) dogs
 - d) fish
9. 🌟 **More and more cities are banning the sale of fireworks because...**
 - a) nobody likes them
 - b) they are too cheap
 - c) the noise terrifies animals
 - d) they are too quiet



ANIMAL SCIENCE AND FISHERIES

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD

Let's look into the farms and fisheries of our times. Aquaculture, or fish farming, today provides about half of the fish eaten worldwide. Cod fishing in the eastern Baltic has been banned since 2019, and because the Baltic is warming, fish change and oxygen runs low. By choosing MSC-certified fish, you support sustainable fishing. Recordings of coral reef sounds played through speakers help lure fish back to damaged reefs. Honeybees in Poland are threatened by, among other things, varroa mites and pesticides. Insect farming for feed and food is growing because insects provide lots of protein cheaply. The welfare of laying hens is improving because supermarket chains are phasing out caged-hen eggs – and the digit "3" on an egg means the hens were raised in cages. Remember these details – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎵 Recordings of coral reef sounds played through speakers help...
 - a) lure fish back to damaged reefs
 - b) scare off tourists
 - c) play music
 - d) catch sharks
2. 👁 Cod fishing in the eastern Baltic has been banned since...
 - a) 1990
 - b) 1919
 - c) 2025
 - d) 2019
3. 🗨 Today, aquaculture provides...
 - a) 1% of fish
 - b) nothing
 - c) about half of the fish eaten worldwide
 - d) all fish
4. 🐝 Honeybees in Poland are threatened by, among other things, ...
 - a) people in cities
 - b) rain
 - c) varroa mites and pesticides
 - d) flowers
5. 🐛 Insect farming for feed and food is growing because insects...
 - a) provide lots of protein cheaply
 - b) are big
 - c) live forever
 - d) are sweet
6. 🐔 The welfare of laying hens is improving because supermarket chains...
 - a) sell only duck eggs
 - b) are buying more cages
 - c) are phasing out caged-hen eggs
 - d) don't sell eggs
7. ❤ The digit "3" on an egg means the hens were raised...
 - a) organically
 - b) free-range
 - c) in barns
 - d) in cages
8. 🌿 Because the Baltic Sea is warming,...
 - a) fish always multiply
 - b) the sea is disappearing
 - c) fish change and oxygen runs low
 - d) the water is freezing
9. ☆ By choosing MSC-certified fish, consumers support...
 - a) sustainable fishing
 - b) illegal fishing
 - c) overfishing
 - d) cage farming

OTHER (NATURE)

11. Present Day

2020–2025 AD



Let's set out into the nature of our times. The pandemic showed that nature and people are closely connected. Scientists record the sounds of forests and meadows, because such soundscapes help assess biodiversity, and the Sentinel satellites of the Copernicus program make it possible to monitor Earth's environment. In 2021 the first winter ascent of K2 was made by a team of Nepalese climbers, and the lines on Mount Everest highlight the problem of overtourism in the mountains. In February 2023 the earthquake in Turkey and Syria had a magnitude of about 7.8. In 2023–2025 the volcano near Grindavík in Iceland erupted, forcing evacuations. In 2024 the northern lights could be seen over Poland in May and October, among other months. And the Bartek Oak, one of the most famous old oaks in Poland, is several hundred years old. Remember these phenomena – I'll ask you about them in a moment.

Read the story aloud. On the back: 9 questions – the answers are in the text.

Place: the field your pawn stands on – link it to the story, or use the app to hear that field's own story.

1. 🎧 **Recording the sounds of forests and meadows (soundscapes) helps scientists...**
 - a) assess biodiversity
 - b) control the weather
 - c) give concerts
 - d) count tourists
2. 👁️ **In 2024, the northern lights could be seen over Poland in, among other months, ...**
 - a) the daytime
 - b) never
 - c) May and October
 - d) July only
3. 🗨️ **The earthquake in Turkey and Syria in February 2023 had a magnitude of about...**
 - a) 0.8
 - b) 2.8
 - c) 12
 - d) 7.8
4. 🗺️ **In 2023–2025, the volcano near Grindavík in Iceland...**
 - a) was artificial
 - b) erupted, forcing evacuations
 - c) went extinct forever
 - d) turned into a glacier
5. 🧗 **The lines of climbers on Mount Everest in 2020–2025 highlight the problem of...**
 - a) a lack of snow
 - b) too few people
 - c) overtourism in the mountains
 - d) a lack of mountains
6. 🧗 **The first winter ascent of K2 (2021) was made by...**
 - a) a Japanese team
 - b) an American team
 - c) a Polish team
 - d) a team of Nepalese climbers
7. ❤️ **One of the most famous old oaks in Poland, the Bartek Oak, is about...**
 - a) 50 years old
 - b) 5 years old
 - c) 5,000 years old
 - d) several hundred years old
8. 🌿 **The Sentinel satellites of the Copernicus program make it possible to...**
 - a) navigate cars
 - b) connect phone calls
 - c) broadcast television
 - d) monitor Earth's environment
9. ⭐ **The pandemic showed that nature and people are...**
 - a) strangers to each other
 - b) independent
 - c) closely connected
 - d) enemies